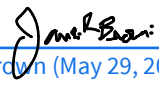


James R. Brown
Jeanne & John R. Blocker Chair in Business Administration
Professor and Department Head

MEMORANDUM

TO: Peter Cziraki, Assistant Professor, Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance

FROM: Jamie Brown, Head, Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance 
Jamie Brown (May 29, 2025 11:14 CDT)

SUBJECT: Annual Performance Review: January 1, 2024 – December 31, 2024

Both Texas A&M University and Mays Business School require that the performance of all faculty be reviewed on an annual basis. As noted in the Mays Faculty Promotion and Tenure Guidelines, the purposes of the annual performance review include:

- Creating a sound and logical basis for merit compensation recommendations
- Providing evaluative feedback regarding how well the individual is currently performing
- Providing developmental feedback regarding areas where the faculty member's contribution may be enhanced and/or improved in the future
- Providing feedback regarding progress toward promotion and/or tenure as relevant

Further, the Mays Faculty Promotion and Tenure Guidelines define four levels of performance for the key dimensions across which performance is reviewed. These levels of performance are:

- *Excellent performance*: a high level of performance that meets and exceeds norms and expectations and that is reflected by substantive indicators of *excellence*;
- *Effective performance*: performance that meets norms and expectations and that is reflected by substantive indicators of *effective* performance;
- *Needs improvement performance*: performance that falls below norms and expectations of *effective* performance as reflected by substantive indicators of *needs improvement* performance;
- *Unsatisfactory performance*: performance that falls below norms and expectations of *excellent*, *effective*, and *needs improvement* performance as reflected by substantive indicators of *unsatisfactory* performance.

This letter serves as your performance review for the 2024 calendar year. The following reflects information provided in your Faculty 180 submission. In addition, the tenured Finance faculty had the opportunity to review your annual report (containing detailed information about your research, teaching, and service) and current resume and provided me with their assessment and feedback. In the sections below, I first briefly summarize the main contributions you have made in each area, present the assessment of the tenured faculty, and provide my own independent assessment.

Research

Highlights of your research activity during the three-year evaluation window include:

- One co-authored paper published in the *Review of Corporate Finance Studies*.
- One co-authored paper received a revise and resubmit from the *Journal of Finance* in 2021, which is being prepared for resubmission later this year.
- Two additional working papers.
- Active participation in quality conferences such as the American Economic Association Annual Meeting and SFS Cavalcade and seminars at University of New South Wales, University of Technology Sydney, and Australian National University.
- Just outside of the (2024) evaluation period: i) appointed a member of the European Corporate Governance Institute in 2025, and ii) a co-authored paper received a revise and resubmit from the *Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis* in February 2025.

Teaching

- Taught two different MBA courses
- Received a 3.9 out of 5 rating for instructor effectiveness in Finance for Professional
- Received excellent teaching evaluations (i.e., 4.67/5 and 4.88/5) in Finance for Professional II

Service

- Member of the junior faculty recruiting committee
- Reviewed a total of 17 manuscripts in 2024, including six for top-three finance journals

Tenured Faculty Assessment

The consensus among the tenured faculty is that your research performance is satisfactory. We are pleased that you received a revise-and-resubmit from the *Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis* in February 2025, which falls just outside the current evaluation period. You also have a revise-and-resubmit from the *Journal of Finance* dating back to 2021. Given that this is now over three years old, we strongly encourage you to complete the revision and resubmit it soon. While you already have four publications in A- journals, you will need additional publications in top-three finance journals to demonstrate your ability to publish at that level. This will be critical for your tenure case to have a realistic chance of success.

In addition, earning tenure will require you to demonstrate an independent ability to publish in leading journals. While your revise-and-resubmit at the *Journal of Finance* is a positive step, it is also important that you have publications at this level with non-senior coauthors to clearly establish your role as the lead contributor. We therefore encourage you to prioritize projects coauthored with students or junior faculty and to target top-three finance journals.

As you will see below, six of the tenured faculty rated your teaching performance as “excellent,” and three rated it as “satisfactory.” The department appreciates your contribution in teaching two different courses in the MBA program. We also appreciate the effort you have put into developing new and challenging courses.

The consensus among the tenured faculty is that your service performance is excellent. We appreciate your active contributions to the department and the profession. In particular, your outstanding efforts in this year’s junior recruiting process are highly valued. You are also regarded as an excellent colleague, and your enthusiasm is widely appreciated. The tenured faculty noted that you are completing a large number of referee reports each year. While we commend your service to the profession, we advise you to reduce your refereeing load and allocate more time to your own research going forward.

Ratings (votes) from Tenured Faculty

Research: Effective (9)

Teaching: Excellent (6), Effective (3)

Service: Excellent (9)

As a colleague: Excellent (9)

Department Head Assessment

I agree with the assessment of the tenured faculty. Congratulations on seeing the *RCFS* in print! I fully support your goals for 2025. Most importantly, you need to move the papers with revise and resubmits toward publication, ideally finalizing both the *JF* and *JFQA* papers during this calendar year. Please let me know what the department can do to help you meet these goals!

Your mid-term review is scheduled for Fall 2026, which will be here before you know it. Converting the *JF* paper and moving the other papers forward will put you on track for a favorable mid-term review but given the low acceptance rates and long turnaround times at the top journals, you have work to do to build a tenurable record by the time of your mandatory P&T review in 2028-29. You have a strong record of publishing in high-quality journals, and you also have an impressive record of impact (citations) for an untenured assistant professor. You are also clearly known and appreciated (as a referee) by the discipline. However, as the tenured faculty mention, you will also need to publish in the premier (top-three) finance journals to meet the tenure expectations at TAMU. Further, while your primary focus should be on publishing your existing papers in top-three outlets, please note the feedback from senior faculty on the need to also demonstrate an independent ability to publish in the leading journals.

Your teaching and service contributions are excellent for an untenured assistant professor. I greatly appreciate your active engagement in department service, particularly related to tenure-track hiring. However, I encourage you to not let these service activities unnecessarily detract you from moving your own research forward. Similarly, while I know how hard it is to turn down referee requests, particularly from the top journals, I think you are now in a position where you need to prioritize your own research.

Thank you very much for your contributions to the Adam C. Sinn '00 Department of Finance and Mays Business School. It is a pleasure to work with you!

Please acknowledge receipt of this evaluation by signing below. Note that your signature does not indicate your agreement with the contents of this evaluation.



Peter Cziraki

05/30/2025

Date

Cziraki 2024 Annual Review

Final Audit Report

2025-05-30

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